

SAYING NO

There are four different nos.

How to decline without burning the relationship.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

Almost nothing needs the final one, and that is exactly the one we fear.

THE CASCADE

The automatic yes cycle.

WHAT YOU SEE

The request lands and you say yes on the spot, to avoid friction...

THE MECHANISM

...the queue grows and everything carries the same deadline...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the bill arrives as a bad delivery or a delay.

The automatic yes does not avoid the conflict, it postpones and inflates it.

THE FORK

Before answering, find the real ask.

FIND THE ASK

01

What problem does he want solved? Not always what he asked for.

02

Is the urgency his or the business's?

03

If I say yes, what leaves the queue? That is the math to show.

Saying yes without showing what leaves the queue is promising the same hours twice.

THE METHOD

The four nos.



01 NOT NOW

I can start on this date, given what is already queued

02 NOT LIKE THIS

the way you asked will not fit, this other way I can deliver

03 NOT ME

the person who does this best is her, I will connect you now

04 NOT AT ALL

the only final one, and always accompanied by the reason

Almost everything we swallow out of fear was a not now with a date.

WHAT TO SAY, IN ORDER

What to say, literally.

01 • NOT NOW

I can start on the tenth.

right now I have this and that, do you want me to swap the order?

02 • NOT LIKE
THIS**The full scope will not fit the deadline.**

I can deliver this part now and the rest afterward

03 • NOT ME

The person who owns this is her.

I will bring her in today and sit in on the first conversation

04 • NOT AT ALL

This I am not going to do, and here is why.

it would compromise another delivery already promised to a client

TWO MODELS

A no that shuts the door or one that builds.

THE COMMON MODEL

Shuts the door

Declines with no explanation

Talks about your calendar problem

Offers no path at all

Leaves the other person stuck

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Builds

Shows what leaves the queue

Talks about the impact on their result

Offers a date, a scope or a person

Leaves the other person deciding with you

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three ways to decline that cost dearly.

01 Saying yes and not delivering.

- the worst no of all, because it arrives late and unannounced.

02 Declining by citing only your own overload.

- they did not buy your calendar, they have a problem to solve.

03 Declining by email, with no conversation.

- a written no sounds twice as hard as a spoken one.

The relationship does not break over the no. It breaks over the yes that was not kept.

THE CHAIN

The automatic yes test.

01

Count how many yeses you gave this week.



02

In how many did you check the calendar first?



03

If the number is low, you are not accepting, you are postponing.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Every yes given without checking the queue is a delay booked three weeks out.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to answer the next request.



STEP 01

Buy one hour before answering.

give me until end of day and I will come back with a date, is a valid answer



STEP 02

Ask what problem he wants solved.

in many cases there is a cheaper path than the original request



STEP 03

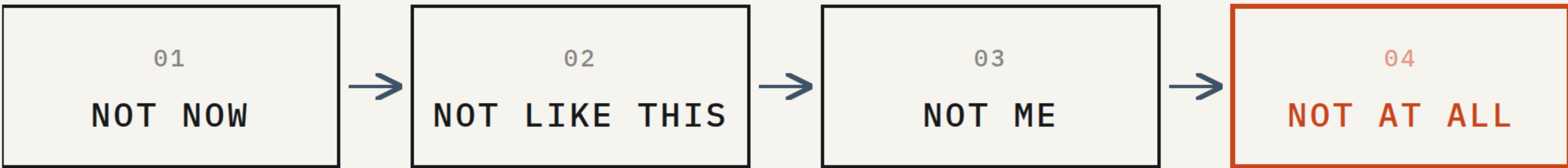
Choose which of the four nos applies, and use the line.

with a date, an alternative or a name, never with the refusal alone

Whoever never says no has a devalued word when they say yes.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Four Nos, in the order that matters.



The relationship does not break over the no.
It breaks over the yes that is not kept.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

on the next urgent request that lands in your lap.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA